

Another year, another benchmark: Digit Zero1 Awards 2025 celebrate the best

It's been little over 18 months since Digit became a part of the Times Network family. We announced ourselves with last year's Digit Zero1 Awards. That's when the industry took serious note of this partnership. And, with this year's Zero1 Awards, we are pushing the envelope for gold standard in tech awards in India.

At Digit, we believe in a simple idea: test technology the hard way, with methods that could survive scrutiny, repetition and time. That ethos has defined the Digit Zero1 Awards since their inception, and in 2025, as we wrap another testing cycle across hundreds of products, one thing is clear – this year's edition wasn't just successful. It was a testament to teamwork, resilience and the relentless pursuit of testing excellence.

One of the biggest shifts this year was our testing team itself. Compared to last year, we had a reasonably new crew stepping into some of the most demanding roles in tech journalism. And yet, they didn't just match expectations, they exceeded them.

In Noida, our teams were focused on phones, audio, TVs and laptops. Meanwhile, Mumbai took charge of PCs, components and the vast ecosystem of peripherals that make modern computing tick. Between these two hubs, we tested, re-tested, benchmarked and stress-tested every category with the precision that our readers expect.

A show of this scale rests on the shoulders of many, but a few people went above and beyond across the past several months.

- Mithun, for instance, has been doing some serious heavy lifting since the beginning of this cycle. Balancing brand expectations with internal coordination is a high-wire act, and he executed it with unwavering calm. For nearly two months, he has been the glue holding the editorial, brand and events sides together, ensuring that what we deliver is not



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Technology Editor,
Times Network



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just an awards issue, but a spectacle worthy of the Digit name.

- On the magazine front, Jayesh, Baiju and Vyom have practically been running the press at midnight. They have been ensuring the magazine goes out on time... every time.

- In Noida, Aman has been holding the fort with quiet strength and absolute reliability. Working alongside Siddharth, Divyanshi, Vasanth, Yash and Ashish, this team has spent late nights and countless weekends completing write-ups, validating results, aligning data and putting the editorial engine into overdrive. They are the reason the testing pipeline kept moving. They are the reason we could wrap categories without compromise.

- Over in the studio, Apurva and Narender have been producing funny, sharp and high-quality content that kept the buzz alive across channels. In a year when attention is harder to win than ever, their work ensured that Digit stayed front-and-centre in conversations around the biggest tech of 2025.

And then, speaking personally, this was a new role for me too. While I continued hosting The Digit Show and handling the magazine with Jayesh, the brand responsibilities grew significantly. Conceptualising the Zero1 Awards, locking themes, planning the narrative, working with the events team and shaping the entire on-ground spectacle – this was an entirely new layer of responsibility. And yet, with this team behind me, the process was as fulfilling as it was challenging.

And finally, because technology isn't shaped only in labs but also in the hands of its users, we introduce the Popular Choice Awards 2025. Excited for this new addition, based on our community insights!

As we close this edition, there's a certain pride in looking back. Not just at the winners, but at what it took to get here. Proud to say: we cooked and delivered another hit. **1**